



Slovenian / University

# Every Seat Accounted For

A promise every room can check



# Why Slop University

A university runs on rooms, and a room only works if the right number of people can find a seat in it. At Slop University, that promise starts long before the first lecture: a classroom-fit index reads enrolment against capacity every term, matching cohort to theatre, desk to demand, so that showing up is never a gamble.

The work behind that promise is research in its own right. Across the School of Emergent Priorities, our researchers build, test, and quietly interrogate the instruments the University leans on — the sensor that counts a bike corral, the forecast that stocks a laptop loan desk, the index that sets a lecture theatre's capacity for the term ahead. Some findings confirm what the index already believed. Others don't, and those are published just as readily.

This brochure is an invitation into that habit: a university that doesn't just measure its own campus, but studies the measuring, in public, term after term. Read on for the rooms, the researchers, and the record.



# By the Numbers

Slop University’s capacity instruments touch every part of a student’s week — here’s a sense of the ground they cover.



## Every Cohort, Counted

From first lecture to final exam, the University tracks how many students arrive and builds capacity to match, so nobody is left standing at the door.



## Instruments Built In-House

Every measurement the University relies on — a seating count, a sensor reading, a loan forecast — is built, tested, and maintained by our own researchers.



## Research That Follows the Room

Our researchers don’t just study the numbers; they follow them into lecture theatres, bike corrals, and library counters to see what the numbers miss.

# Where Ideas Count

## The room the index promises

Every subject at Slop University is assigned its lecture theatre months before term begins, matched by a classroom-fit index that reads a cohort’s projected size against the University’s inventory of rooms. The index doesn’t just allocate — it anticipates, folding in withdrawal patterns, cross-enrolment, and the small, steady drift between an offer and an arrival, so that the room a student walks into on day one is, in the University’s language, already the right size.

The Trajectory Analytics Group treats that promise as a live research question rather than a settled fact. Its work follows the index’s projections out of the timetabling office and into the theatre itself, term after term, checking what the index expected against what the room actually held. The findings feed straight back into how the index is built, which is, the School argues, the whole point of building one in the first place.





A number that predicts a full room and a room that turns out half-empty are both telling you something. We're just as interested in the second kind of finding as the first.

— Fenna Okoro, Senior Lecturer and Convenor, Horizon Register, School of Emergent Priorities

## What the sensors are really counting

Look closely enough at any part of the campus and there's an instrument watching it: a counter above a bike corral, a light-beam across a doorway, a badge reader at a bay door. Slop University doesn't treat these as background infrastructure. Each one feeds a capacity decision somewhere else in the institution — how many bike racks to build, how many desks to open, how many staff to roster on — and each one is, by design, available to be checked.

That checking is a research program of its own within the School of Emergent Priorities, matching what an instrument reports against what a person standing in the same place would say. The two don't always agree, and when they don't, the University treats the gap as the interesting result rather than something to quietly recalibrate away. It's a slower way to run a sensor network. It's also, the School would argue, the only honest one.



“A sensor doesn’t know what it’s counting until someone checks. That’s the part of the job nobody automates,” says Lindiwe Achterberg, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities.

## Forecasting under pressure

A forecast is easiest to trust in an ordinary week. Slop University’s research instead follows its forecasting systems into the weeks that strain them — exam period, orientation, the return from a long break — when demand for a shared resource spikes all at once and a forecast either holds or it doesn’t.

The School’s work compares forecast-fed allocation against the plainer alternative of staff judgement on the day, run side by side rather than one after the other, so neither gets credit for conditions the other didn’t face. The results inform how far the University leans on a forecast versus a person with a clipboard, and the answer, so far, is: it depends which week you ask.



“A forecast that gets the average right can still fail the one week that matters. We build for that week,” says Marek Solheim, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities.

## From Our Researchers

Four recent studies from the School of Emergent Priorities put the University’s own capacity instruments to the test — read them in full, DOI and all.

- **Booked Full, Sat Empty** — A term of lecture-theatre attendance is set against the Timetabling Office’s own occupancy forecast, tracking how closely a room’s booked capacity matches who actually shows up. [doi:10.5555/slop.qeq1w5](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.qeq1w5)
- **Pre-Allocated, Not Prevented** — Two library branches, one running a week-ahead loaner-laptop forecast and one allocating by feel, are compared across the pressure of exam week. [doi:10.5555/slop.rssr33](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.rssr33)
- **Validating the Corral Occupancy Sensor** — An unannounced manual headcount checks the sensor reading that sets next term’s bike-rack capacity across the campus’s share-scooter corrals. [doi:10.5555/slop.gdacz4](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.gdacz4)
- **Quiet, Then Counted** — A term of referral-log entries from the Learning Commons’ overflow desk is coded against the capacity reason the log was built to track. [doi:10.5555/slop.th7iml](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.th7iml)

# The People Behind the Work

**Anouk Mensah**, Postdoctoral Fellow, School of Emergent Priorities — traces how a planning phrase outlives the plan that coined it, work that sits close to the University's own habit of renaming a problem before it's solved.

**Lindiwe Achterberg**, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities — follows programs that stay in trial status year after year, and the paperwork that keeps them there without ever calling it permanent.

**Marek Solheim**, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities — studies what becomes of a priority once the University has quietly stopped pursuing it, and who signs off on the ending.

## Be Part of It

Every seat at Slop University is somebody's research question before it's anybody's classroom. If that's the kind of institution you want to study in, fund, or simply visit, there's a place in it for you.

Prospective students find a University that takes the size of their cohort as seriously as its content. Partners and donors find a research program that keeps its own instruments honest, in public, and publishes what it finds either way. Visitors find a campus willing to show you the sensor as readily as the seminar.

Find the full record, room by room, at [slop.university](http://slop.university).



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